

JOB AUTOMATION WITH CRONJOBS

TASKS

1.Create a cronjob that runs every day at 8:00 AM and appends the current date and time to a file named mylog.txt in your home directory.

Create a Cronjob (Every day at 8:00 AM)

Step 1: Open crontab

crontab -e

Step 2: Add this line

0 8 * * * date >> /root/mylog.txt

Save:

Esc

:wq

Step 3: Verify

crontab -l

```
[root@localhost ~]# crontab -e
no crontab for root - using an empty one
crontab: installing new crontab
[root@localhost ~]# crontab -l
0 8 * * * date >> /root/mylog.txt
[root@localhost ~]#
```

**2.Set up a cronjob to back up a folder named 'music' from your Downloads directory to a 'backup_music' folder inside your Documents every Sunday at 11:30 PM.

Hint: Use the cp -r command in your cronjob.**

Backup Downloads/music Every Sunday 11:30 PM

Step 1: Create folders

mkdir -p /root/Downloads/music

mkdir -p /root/Documents/backup_music

Create sample file

```
touch /root/Downloads/music/song1.mp3
```

Step 2: Open crontab

```
crontab -e
```

Add:

```
30 23 * * 0 cp -r /root/Downloads/music /root/Documents/backup_music
```

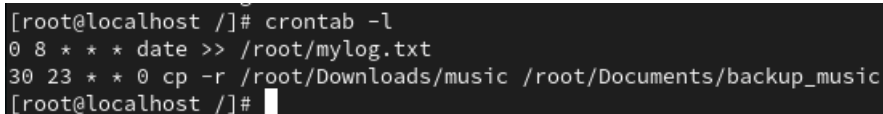
Save:

Esc

:wq

Step 3: Verify

```
crontab -l
```

A terminal window screenshot showing the output of the 'crontab -l' command. The output lists three cron jobs: one to log the date every 8 minutes to /root/mylog.txt, and another to recursively copy the contents of /root/Downloads/music to /root/Documents/backup_music every day at 23:30. The prompt is [root@localhost /]#.

```
[root@localhost /]# crontab -l
0 8 * * * date >> /root/mylog.txt
30 23 * * 0 cp -r /root/Downloads/music /root/Documents/backup_music
[root@localhost /]#
```

3. Write a cronjob that deletes all .tmp files from your Desktop every hour and logs the deleted filenames to a file called deleted_tmp.log.

Delete .tmp Files Every Hour

Step 1: Create Desktop

```
mkdir -p /root/Desktop
```

Create sample files

```
touch /root/Desktop/test1.tmp
```

```
touch /root/Desktop/test2.tmp
```

```
touch /root/Desktop/test3.tmp
```

Step 2: Open crontab

```
crontab -e
```

Add:

```
0 * * * * find /root/Desktop -name "*.tmp" -exec rm {} \; >>
/root/deleted_tmp.log 2>&1
```

Save:

Esc

:wq

Step 3: Verify

crontab -l

```
[root@localhost ~]# crontab -e
crontab: installing new crontab
[root@localhost ~]# crontab -l
0 8 * * * date >> /root/mylog.txt
30 23 * * 0 cp -r /root/Downloads/music /root/Documents/backup_music
0 * * * * find /root/Desktop -name "*.tmp" -exec rm {} \; >> /root/deleted_tmp.log 2>&1
[root@localhost ~]#
```

4. Temporarily disable a cronjob that prints 'Time for a break!' every 2 hours, without deleting the job. Then, re-enable it after 5 minutes.
Hint: Use the comment (#) character to disable and enable lines in your crontab.

Disable and Enable Cronjob

Step 1: Open crontab

crontab -e

Suppose you have:

```
8 * * * * date >> /root/mylog.txt
```

Disable it

Add #

```
#8 * * * * date >> /root/mylog.txt
```

Save:

Esc

:wq

Verify

crontab -l

```
[root@localhost /]# crontab -l
#0 8 * * * date >> /root/mylog.txt
30 23 * * 0 cp -r /root/Downloads/music /root/Documents/backup_music
0 * * * * find /root/Desktop -name "*.tmp" -exec rm {} \; >> /root/deleted_tmp.log 2>&1
[root@localhost /]#
```

Enable Again

Edit

crontab -e

Remove

8 * * * date >> /root/mylog.txt

Save:

Esc

:wq

Change to Every 5 Minutes

Replace with

*/5 * * * * echo "Time for a break!" >> /root/break.txt

Verify

crontab -l

```
[root@localhost /]# crontab -e
crontab: installing new crontab
[root@localhost /]# crontab -l
*/5 * * * * echo "Time for a break!" >> /root/break.txt
30 23 * * 0 cp -r /root/Downloads/music /root/Documents/backup_music
0 * * * * find /root/Desktop -name "*.tmp" -exec rm {} \; >> /root/deleted_tmp.log 2>&1
[root@localhost /]#
```

5. Use ChatGPT or another AI tool to generate a cron expression for running a script every weekday at 7:45 PM, then test it by creating a cronjob that echoes 'Dinner Reminder' into dinner.txt at the scheduled time.

Dinner Reminder Every Weekday at 7:45 PM

Step 1: Open crontab

crontab -e

Add:

```
45 19 * * 1-5 echo "Dinner Reminder" >> /root/dinner.txt
```

Save:

Esc

:wq

Step 2: Verify

crontab -l

```
[root@localhost /]# crontab -l
*/5 * * * * echo "Time for a break!" >> /root/break.txt
30 23 * * 0 cp -r /root/Downloads/music /root/Documents/backup_music
0 * * * * find /root/Desktop -name "*.tmp" -exec rm {} \; >> /root/deleted_tmp.log 2>&1
45 19 * * 1-5 echo "Dinner Reminder" >> /root/dinner.txt
[root@localhost /]#
```